Sam Rivera | Staff Software Engineer

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PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

Staff engineer with 12+ years building data-intensive backend systems and developer platforms. Comfortable leading cross-team technical initiatives, mentoring engineers and turning ambiguous problems into reliable, well-documented services. All data in this profile is fictional.

EXPERIENCE

Tidewater Labs January 2022 – Present
Staff Software Engineer
Observability and developer platform company · Lisbon, Portugal

- Redesigned the event ingestion pipeline, cutting p99 latency from 1.8s to 350ms while tripling throughput.
- Introduced service-level objectives and error budgets across 14 services, reducing paging incidents by 45%.
- Mentored six engineers, two of whom were promoted to senior; ran the internal technical-writing guild.

Lumen Analytics September 2018 – December 2021
Senior Software Engineer
Business intelligence SaaS · Porto, Portugal

- Built a columnar query layer that made dashboards 8x faster for the largest customers.
- Led the migration from a single PostgreSQL cluster to a sharded architecture with zero planned downtime.
- Created the internal data-contract process adopted by all product teams.

Brightpath Software June 2016 – August 2018
Full-Stack Developer
Product consultancy · Lisbon, Portugal

- Shipped 11 customer projects end to end, from discovery to production support.
- Standardized the team's CI/CD templates, halving the time to set up a new project.

Cobalt Freight Systems July 2014 – May 2016
Software Developer
Logistics software · Lisbon, Portugal

- Implemented a route-optimization service that reduced fleet mileage by 9%.
- Replaced nightly batch jobs with an event-driven tracking pipeline.

Kestrel Studio September 2012 – June 2014
Junior Web Developer
Digital agency · Lisbon, Portugal

- Developed 20+ responsive marketing sites with a focus on accessibility and performance.

PROJECTS

Pipeline Observatory | Open source · Creator, Maintainer March 2021 – Present
Open-source tool that traces data lineage across batch and streaming pipelines.

- 2.4k GitHub stars; used in production by 30+ companies.
- Plugin system with 12 community-contributed connectors.

Go, Kafka, OpenTelemetry

Schema Sentinel | Author May 2023 – Present
Data-contract linter that blocks breaking schema changes in CI.

- Adopted by 40 repositories at Tidewater Labs within six months.

TypeScript, JSON Schema, GitHub Actions

Fluent Forms | Open source · Creator April 2019 – June 2022
Accessible, headless form library for React.

- Zero-dependency core of 4 KB; full keyboard and screen-reader support.

React, TypeScript, Accessibility

cv-factory October 2026 – Present
CLI that renders tailored, ATS-friendly CVs from a single structured source of truth.
- Variants, bilingual content and swappable templates from one JSON file.

TypeScript, Typst, JSON Schema

SKILLS

Languages (Expert): TypeScript, SQL
Systems & data languages (Expert): Go, Python
Backend & Data (Expert): Node.js, PostgreSQL, Kafka, Redis, gRPC
Platform & Cloud (Advanced): Kubernetes, Terraform, AWS, Observability
Frontend (Advanced): React, Accessibility, Web Performance, Design Systems
Leadership: Technical strategy, Mentoring, Technical writing

EDUCATION

Distributed Computing 2010 – 2012
Riverside Institute of Technology | Master of Science
GPA 18/20
Courses: Distributed Systems, Database Internals, Performance Engineering

Computer Science 2007 – 2010
Lakeview University | Bachelor of Science
GPA 16/20

CERTIFICATIONS

- Cloud Architecture Professional – Example Cloud Institute (March 2025)
- Kubernetes Operations Specialist – Open Orchestration Foundation (September 2024)
- Secure Software Engineering – Secure Code Alliance (February 2024)
- Data Engineering Professional – Data Guild (October 2023)
- Site Reliability Practitioner – Reliability Institute (June 2023)
- Advanced TypeScript – Frontend Craft Academy (January 2023)
- Distributed Systems Fundamentals – Systems School (August 2022)
- Agile Leadership – Leadership Lab (March 2022)
- PostgreSQL Performance – Database Workshop (November 2021)
- Web Accessibility Specialist – Inclusive Web Organization (May 2021)
- Scrum Practitioner – Agile Forum (September 2019)
- Linux Administration – Open Systems Academy (April 2018)

AWARDS

Engineering Excellence Award December 2024
Tidewater Labs
Recognized for the ingestion platform redesign.

Best Open-Source Tool October 2022
Data Infrastructure Conference
Community vote for Pipeline Observatory.

PUBLICATIONS

Error Budgets in Practice April 2024
Reliability Engineering Journal
A field study of adopting service-level objectives across 14 services.

Data Contracts Without the Ceremony August 2023
Samrivera.example.com/blog
A lightweight approach to schema governance for product teams.

VOLUNTEERING

Technical Mentor, Code for Communities February 2020 – Present
Mentor in a non-profit program that teaches programming to career changers.
- Mentored 25+ learners; 18 landed their first developer job.
- Designed the backend curriculum used in three cohorts.

Contributor, Open Data Lisbon March 2017 – December 2019
Built civic-data tools with a volunteer community.

- Maintained a public transit data API used by two city apps.

LANGUAGES

English : Full professional proficiency
Portuguese : Native
Spanish : Professional working proficiency